

Competency Assessment Rubric - level 6

Assessment Context: During your demonstration, your assessor will act as a client or stakeholder. As cybersecurity professionals regularly present technical work to line managers, clients, and cross-functional teams, your ability to communicate complex work clearly and respond to questions professionally is a core competency being assessed.

1. Clarity and Definition of Individual Tasks and Responsibilities (Maximum 15 marks)

What is being assessed: Your ability to clearly explain and present your individual tasks and responsibilities within the project.

Guidance: Explain what you were responsible for, describing each task's scope, method, and purpose. Structure your explanation logically by starting with an overview, then adding detail.

Ensure the client understands exactly what you did and communicate confidently and respond effectively to any follow up questions.

Grade Boundary	Mark Range	Criteria
Non-Submission	0 marks	No information is provided about individual tasks and responsibilities.
Inadequate	5 marks	Severely limited definition of tasks and responsibilities. Descriptions are extremely vague, incomplete, and lack meaningful detail. Unable to clearly articulate what was done.
Adequate	7 marks	Tasks and responsibilities are vaguely defined with significant gaps. Descriptions are ambiguous, lacking specific details about what was required. Limited or no timeline information provided.
Good	9 marks	Tasks and responsibilities are defined with reasonable clarity. Good description of what each task entailed is provided with some timeline information. Minor gaps or ambiguities present.
Very Good	12 marks	Tasks and responsibilities are clearly defined with good detail. Comprehensive descriptions of requirements, deliverables, and timelines. Logical organisation of information.
Excellent	15 marks	Tasks and responsibilities are exceptionally well-defined with excellent detail and precision. Exemplary descriptions of requirements, deliverables, and timelines. Information is presented in a highly organised, systematic manner that demonstrates excellent planning and execution.

2. Evidence of Task Completion (Maximum 15 marks)

What is being assessed: Your ability to provide clear, credible evidence that your tasks have been completed successfully.

Guidance: Provide screenshots, configuration files, scripts, logs, live dashboards, documentations, or other relevant artefacts that prove you did the work. Generic team outputs are not sufficient. Your evidence should clearly show your personal contributions and be organised for easy verification during the demonstration.

Grade Boundary	Mark Range	Criteria
Non-Submission	0 marks	No evidence of task completion is provided.
Inadequate	5 marks	Critically insufficient evidence is provided. Fragments of evidence that are largely irrelevant, unverifiable, or fail to demonstrate any meaningful task completion.
Adequate	7 marks	Minimal evidence provided. Demonstration and/or documentation are sparse, inconsistent, or irrelevant. Claims of completion without adequate supporting evidence.
Good	9 marks	Good evidence of task completion provided. Demonstration and documentation show completion of main tasks, though some evidence may lack detail or comprehensiveness.
Very Good	12 marks	Strong evidence of task completion provided. Demonstration and documentation are thorough and well-organised, clearly demonstrating the completion of all tasks.
Excellent	15 marks	Exceptional evidence of task completion provided. Comprehensive documentation is meticulously organised and presented, demonstrating completion of all tasks to a high standard. Evidence includes verification of outcomes and effectiveness where appropriate.

3. Alignment/Relevance of Individual Tasks to the Project Context (Maximum 15 marks)

What is being assessed: How well your individual work supports the project's objectives and requirements, demonstrating strategic, shared goals and thinking and not just completing your own tasks.

Guidance: Explain how your work fits into the bigger picture. Why was your task necessary for the project's success? How does it address the security scenario and the requirements? Be ready to discuss dependencies and integration points with the work of other team members.

Grade Boundary	Mark Range	Criteria
Non-Submission	0 marks	No information is provided about alignment with project context.
Inadequate	5 marks	Misaligned tasks with little to no relation to the project. Unable to explain how work relates to project objectives.
Adequate	7 marks	Tasks and responsibilities generally align with the project but with limited explanation or limited understanding of how individual contributions fit into the broader project.
Good	9 marks	Tasks and responsibilities align with the project context. Good understanding and explanation of how individual contributions support project objectives.
Very Good	12 marks	Tasks and responsibilities clearly align with the project context and appropriately scoped. Good understanding demonstrated how individual contributions integrate with and advance project objectives.
Excellent	15 marks	Tasks and responsibilities clearly align with the project context and appropriately scoped. Excellent understanding demonstrated how individual contributions integrate with and advance project objectives and how they align with other tasks.

4. Articulation of Tasks, Knowledge, Skills and Abilities Acquired (Maximum 15 marks)

What is being assessed: Your depth of technical understanding of the tools, techniques, and concepts you applied in your work to acquire competence, and any new skills you gained in the project.

Guidance: Explain how the tools work, not just what you implemented. Discuss technical decisions, configurations, and why certain approaches were taken. Show understanding of underlying principles, not just procedural steps.

Grade Boundary	Mark Range	Criteria
Non-Submission	0 marks	No information provided about knowledge, skills, and abilities acquired.
Inadequate	5 marks	Severely deficient articulation of learning. Unable to identify or express any significant knowledge or skills gained. No meaningful reflection on professional development.
Adequate	7 marks	Limited articulation of learning outcomes. Minimal reflection on knowledge, skills, and abilities gained. Connections between tasks and learning are unclear or superficial.
Good	9 marks	Good articulation of learning outcomes. Reasonable reflection on knowledge, skills, and abilities gained. Some clear connections made between tasks and learning, though analysis may lack depth.
Very Good	12 marks	Strong articulation of learning outcomes. Thoughtful reflection on knowledge, skills, and abilities gained. Clear and detailed connections made between tasks and learning, with good analytical depth.
Excellent	15 marks	Exceptional articulation of learning outcomes. Insightful, nuanced reflection on knowledge, skills, and abilities gained. Excellent connections made between tasks and learning, with outstanding analytical depth and awareness of professional development implications.

5. Authenticity and Clarity of a STAR Narrative (Maximum 15 marks)

What is being assessed: Your ability to articulate a professional challenge using the Situation-Task-Action-Result framework, demonstrating reflective practice and interview readiness.

Guidance: Choose a real challenge you faced during the project. Describe the situation and context, your specific responsibility, the actions you took (including alternatives you considered), and the measurable results. Keep it authentic and specific to your work and be ready to show evidence.

- ★ Situation: Describe the security context to help the client understand the environment and specific challenges faced.
- ★ Task: Clearly articulate your specific responsibilities and objectives within this situation, establishing your role and accountability.
- ★ Action: Explain your technical approach with appropriate detail, highlighting critical decision points and methodologies employed.
- ★ Result: Present concrete outcomes, emphasising both technical achievements and business impact.

Grade Boundary	Mark Range	Criteria
Non-Submission	0 marks	No STAR narrative provided.
Inadequate	5 marks	Severely deficient STAR narrative. Most elements (Situation, Task, Action, Result) are missing or unintelligible. Narrative lacks credibility.
Adequate	7 marks	STAR narrative is incomplete or poorly structured. One or more elements (Situation, Task, Action, Result) are missing or inadequately addressed. Narrative lacks authenticity or specific details.
Good	9 marks	STAR narrative covers all required elements. Good description of Situation, Task, Action, and Result provided. Narrative is believable though may lack some detail or clarity in certain areas.
Very Good	12 marks	STAR narrative is well-structured and comprehensive. Detailed description of all elements with clear progression from Situation to Result. Narrative is authentic and provides specific, relevant examples and with evidence.
Excellent	15 marks	STAR narrative is exceptionally well-structured and compelling. Excellent description of all elements with clarity and logical flow. Narrative demonstrates outstanding authenticity with highly specific, relevant examples and evidence.

6. WOW Factor (Maximum 25 marks)

What this assesses: The extent to which your work demonstrates innovation, technical excellence, and professional capability beyond basic requirements.

Guidance: This criterion rewards going beyond the minimum. Did you implement advanced features? Solve difficult technical challenges? Demonstrate exceptional attention to detail or professional polish? Show initiative in identifying and addressing issues? This is your opportunity to stand out.

Grade Boundary	Mark Range	Criteria
Non-Submission	0 marks	No contribution, or elements described do not qualify for a WOW factor.
Inadequate	5 marks	Attempted innovation and creativity, but the implementation was not successful or showed misunderstandings of cyber security principles or professional practice.
Adequate	10 marks	Minimal innovation or creativity, exceed basic expectations. Limited evidence of going beyond standard approaches or requirements.
Good	15 marks	Innovation, creativity, or excellence attempt was good. Some elements exceed basic expectations. Some evidence of going beyond standard approaches or requirements in at least one area.
Very Good	20 marks	Very good attempt in innovation, creativity, or excellence. Many elements exceed expectations. Clear evidence of going beyond standard approaches or requirements in multiple areas. Attempt demonstrates notable technical skill, problem-solving ability, or professional approach.
Excellent	25 marks	Exceptional attempt in innovation, creativity, and excellence. Most or all elements exceed expectations substantially. Compelling evidence of going far beyond standard approaches or requirements across multiple areas. Demonstrated outstanding technical skill, innovative problem-solving, and exemplary professional approach that would be recognised as exceptional even in a professional context.

Total Assessment (Maximum 100 marks)

Overall Grade	Mark Range	General Description
Non-Submission	0 marks	Insufficient work submitted for assessment.
Inadequate	30 - 39 marks	Work demonstrates severe deficiencies in multiple areas. Fails to meet fundamental requirements.
Adequate	40 - 49 marks	Work meets basic standards required.
Good	50-59 marks	Work exceeds basic standards and demonstrates good quality.
Very Good	60-69 marks	Work exceeds basic standards and demonstrates very good quality.
Excellent	70-100 marks	Work substantially exceeds standards and demonstrates excellence.

Best of luck!

End of Rubric.

Last update: February 2026 - Badis Aoun